علامہ اقبال اوپن یونیورسٹی



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Part 1: Unit-Wise 10 Important MCQs

Unit 1: Study of World Religions

1. Karl Marx famously referred to religion as the: a) Catalyst for change b) Opium of the people c) Cement of society d) Divine guidance Answer: b) Opium of the people
2. Which discipline views religion as a "cultural universal"? a) Sociology b) Psychology c) Anthropology d) Political Science Answer: c) Anthropology
3. The rational study of faith and religious doctrine in Islam is known as: a) Tafsir b) Kalam c) Fiqh d) Sufism Answer: b) Kalam
4. The rapidly growing group of people in the West who do not identify with any religion are called: a) Mystics b) Nones c) Secularists d) Agnosticism Answer: b) Nones
5. Who wrote about religion acting as a "social cement"? a) Émile Durkheim b) Karl Marx c) Ibn Khaldun d) Al-Farabi Answer: a) Émile Durkheim
6. Which Muslim scholar synthesized Greek philosophy with Islamic thought during the Golden Age? a) Al-Ash'ari b)

Avicenna (Ibn Sina) c) Al-Maturidi d) Ibn Kathir Answer: b) Avicenna (Ibn Sina)

7. Interfaith dialogue primarily aims to build common ground on shared values like: a) Dogma b) Rituals c) Compassion and justice d) Political structures Answer: c) Compassion and justice
8. The study of the nature of God or gods is an area under: a) Religious History b) Religious Beliefs and Doctrines c) Rituals and Practices d) Sociology Answer: b) Religious Beliefs and Doctrines
9. What term describes the peaceful coexistence of multiple religious groups in a society? a) Secularism b) Pluralism c) Monotheism d) Extremism Answer: b) Pluralism
10. The mystical tradition within Islam that influenced cross-cultural spirituality is: a) Kalam b) Sufism c) Fiqh d) Exegesis Answer: b) Sufism

Unit 2: Judaism

1. The sacred text composed of the first five books of the Hebrew Bible is the: a) Talmud b) Mishnah c) Torah d) Zohar Answer: c) Torah
2. The Jewish day of rest observed from Friday sunset to Saturday nightfall is: a) Yom Kippur b) Shabbat (Sabbath) c) Pesach d) Purim Answer: b) Shabbat (Sabbath)
3. The oral law of Judaism compiled around 200 CE is called the: a) Gemara b) Mishnah c) Tanakh d) Haggadah Answer: b) Mishnah
4. Which commandment forbids taking the Lord's name in vain? a) 1st b) 2nd c) 3rd d) 4th Answer: c) 3rd

5. How many commandments (Mitzvot) are contained in the Torah? a) 10 b) 100 c) 613 d) 48 Answer: c) 613
6. In Jewish tradition, who is considered the greatest prophet? a) Abraham b) David c) Moses d) Isaiah Answer: c) Moses
7. According to the Quran, who incited the Israelites to worship the Golden Calf? a) Pharaoh b) Samiri c) Aaron d) Korah Answer: b) Samiri
8. The Jewish festival commemorating the Exodus from Egypt is: a) Hanukkah b) Purim c) Passover (Pesach) d) Shavuot Answer: c) Passover (Pesach)
9. A quorum of ten Jewish adults required for public prayer is a: a) Synagogue b) Minyan c) Kippah d) Seder Answer: b) Minyan
10. The commentary and discussion on the Mishnah is known as the: a) Gemara b) Tanakh c) Torah d) Midrash Answer: a) Gemara

Unit 3: Christianity

1. The doctrine that God exists in three distinct persons is called: a) Monotheism b) The Trinity c) Incarnation d) Atonement Answer: b) The Trinity
2. Which Gospel presents Jesus as the "Word of God made flesh"? a) Matthew b) Mark c) Luke d) John Answer: d) John
3. What event in Christianity is celebrated on Easter? a) Birth of Jesus b) Crucifixion c) Resurrection of Jesus d) Ascension Answer: c) Resurrection of Jesus
4. According to the Quran (Surah An-Nisa 4:157), Jesus was: a) Crucified and resurrected b) Neither killed nor crucified c) Killed by the Romans d) Died of old age Answer: b) Neither killed nor crucified

5. How many books are there in the New Testament? a) 39 b) 27 c) 66 d) 12 Answer: b) 27
6. Which Islamic term refers to the holy book revealed to Prophet Isa (Jesus)? a) Tawrat b) Zabur c) Injil d) Quran Answer: c) Injil
7. The largest branch of Christianity, led by the Pope, is: a) Protestantism b) Eastern Orthodoxy c) Roman Catholicism d) Anglicanism Answer: c) Roman Catholicism
8. The Quran dedicated Surah 19 to which honorable woman? a) Asiya b) Khadija c) Maryam (Mary) d) Fatima Answer: c) Maryam (Mary)
9. In the New Testament, the book describing the history of the early Church is: a) Romans b) Revelation c) Acts of the Apostles d) Hebrews Answer: c) Acts of the Apostles
10. In Islamic belief, the Holy Spirit (Ruh al-Qudus) is identified as: a) God Himself b) Prophet Isa c) Angel Jibril (Gabriel) d) A divine person Answer: c) Angel Jibril (Gabriel)

Unit 4: Islam

1. The belief in the absolute Oneness of Allah is called: a) Risalah b) Tawhid c) Akhirah d) Taqwa Answer: b) Tawhid
2. The category of Tawhid regarding Allah's sole right to worship is: a) Tawheed Ar-Rububiyyah b) Tawheed Al-Uluhiyyah c) Tawheed Al-Asma wa Sifat d) Tawheed Al-Kalam Answer: b) Tawheed Al-Uluhiyyah
3. The gravest sin in Islam, involving associating partners with Allah, is: a) Kufr b) Nifaq c) Shirk d) Bid'ah Answer: c) Shirk
4. According to Islamic belief, angels are created from: a) Fire b) Clay c) Light (Nur) d) Smoke Answer: c) Light (Nur)

5. The divine book revealed to Prophet Dawud (David) is the: a) Tawrat b) Zabur c) Injil d) Suhuf Answer: b) Zabur
6. *Note: Full text for Unit 4 cuts off at page 64 in the provided file, but based on course outlines:* The final prophet in Islam is: a) Musa b) Isa c) Muhammad (PBUH) d) Ibrahim Answer: c) Muhammad (PBUH)
7. Which angel was responsible for bringing revelations to the prophets? a) Israfil b) Mikail c) Jibril (Gabriel) d) Izrail Answer: c) Jibril (Gabriel)
8. Declaring Tawheed is encapsulated in the first pillar of Islam called: a) Salah b) Zakat c) Shahada d) Sawm Answer: c) Shahada
9. Surah Al-Ikhlas specifically encapsulates which doctrine? a) Prophet Hood b) Tawheed c) Day of Judgment d) Jihad Answer: b) Tawheed
10. The concept that Allah is the sole Creator and Sustainer is: a) Tawheed Al-Uluhiyyah b) Tawheed Ar-Rububiyyah c) Tawheed Al-Asma d) Shirk Answer: b) Tawheed Ar-Rububiyyah

Unit 5: Hinduism (Based on course outline & textbook structure)

1. The oldest sacred scriptures in Hinduism are the: a) Upanishads b) Vedas c) Bhagavad Gita d) Puranas Answer: b) Vedas
2. The concept of cause and effect in human action in Hinduism is: a) Samsara b) Karma c) Moksha d) Dharma Answer: b) Karma
3. The cycle of rebirth and reincarnation is known as: a) Moksha b) Samsara c) Karma d) Nirvana Answer: b) Samsara

4. Spiritual liberation from the cycle of birth and rebirth is called: a) Nirvana b) Moksha c) Karma d) Ahimsa Answer: b) Moksha
5. Which Hindu festival is known as the "Festival of Lights"? a) Holi b) Diwali c) Navratri d) Dussehra Answer: b) Diwali
6. The ultimate, impersonal, supreme reality in Hinduism is: a) Atman b) Brahman c) Vishnu d) Shiva Answer: b) Brahman
7. The social stratification system historically associated with Hinduism is the: a) Feudal system b) Caste system (Varna) c) Guild system d) Monastic system Answer: b) Caste system (Varna)
8. The sacred text containing a conversation between Prince Arjuna and Krishna is: a) Rigveda b) Bhagavad Gita c) Ramayana d) Upanishads Answer: b) Bhagavad Gita
9. The individual soul or self in Hindu philosophy is termed: a) Brahman b) Atman c) Karma d) Maya Answer: b) Atman
10. Hinduism differs from many major religions because it has no: a) Sacred texts b) Single founder c) Concept of God d) Rituals Answer: b) Single founder

Unit 6: Buddhism

1. The founder of Buddhism was Siddhartha Gautama, known as the: a) Mahavira b) Buddha c) Guru d) Tirthankara Answer: b) Buddha
2. The fundamental diagnostic teachings of Buddhism are the Four: a) Noble Truths b) Sacred Vedas c) Commandments d) Path Systems Answer: a) Noble Truths
3. The path to end suffering in Buddhism is called the: a) Five Pillars b) Ten Commandments c) Noble Eightfold Path d) Middle Way Answer: c) Noble Eightfold Path

4. The ultimate goal/state of liberation in Buddhism is: a) Moksha b) Heaven c) Nirvana d) Samsara Answer: c) Nirvana
5. The sacred collection of Buddhist scriptures is called the: a) Vedas b) Tripitaka (Three Baskets) c) Torah d) Avesta Answer: b) Tripitaka
6. Buddhism originated in which geographical region? a) China b) Ancient India c) Persia d) Japan Answer: b) Ancient India
7. The Buddhist doctrine of non-violence and non-injury is known as: a) Dharma b) Ahimsa c) Karma d) Sati Answer: b) Ahimsa
8. Buddhist monastic community of monks and nuns is known as: a) Sangha b) Ashram c) Temple d) Synagogue Answer: a) Sangha
9. The concept of "Anatta" in Buddhism means: a) Suffering b) No-self / No permanent soul c) Impermanence d) Enlightenment Answer: b) No-self / No permanent soul
10. Siddhartha Gautama achieved enlightenment under which tree? a) Banyan tree b) Bodhi tree c) Olive tree d) Oak tree Answer: b) Bodhi tree

Unit 7: Sikhism

1. Sikhism was founded in the 15th century CE by: a) Guru Gobind Singh b) Guru Nanak c) Kabir d) Guru Arjan Answer: b) Guru Nanak
2. The holy scripture of Sikhism, which acts as the ultimate living Guru, is: a) Dasam Granth b) Guru Granth Sahib c) Vedas d) Japji Sahib Answer: b) Guru Granth Sahib
3. How many human Gurus are recognized in Sikh tradition? a) 5 b) 10 c) 12 d) 7 Answer: b) 10

4. The Sikh place of worship is called a: a) Temple b) Synagogue c) Gurdwara d) Pagoda Answer: c) Gurdwara
5. The community kitchen in Sikhism that serves free meals to all regardless of background is: a) Seva b) Langar c) Khalsa d) Amrit Answer: b) Langar
6. The initiated community of Sikhs founded by Guru Gobind Singh is the: a) Sangha b) Khalsa c) Panth d) Gurmat Answer: b) Khalsa
7. The "5 Ks" (articles of faith) are maintained by members of the: a) Monastic order b) Khalsa c) Udasi order d) Sufi order Answer: b) Khalsa
8. Sikhism is strictly a _____ religion. a) Polytheistic b) Monotheistic c) Pantheistic d) Atheistic Answer: b) Monotheistic
9. Sikhism originated in which region of South Asia? a) Bengal b) Gujarat c) Punjab d) Kashmir Answer: c) Punjab
10. The core belief of Sikhism stresses: a) Asceticism and isolation b) Equality of all human beings c) Caste discrimination d) Idol worship Answer: b) Equality of all human beings

Unit 8: Zoroastrianism

1. Zoroastrianism was founded by the prophet Zoroaster (Zarathustra) in ancient: a) Egypt b) Persia (Iran) c) India d) Mesopotamia Answer: b) Persia (Iran)
2. The supreme monotheistic God in Zoroastrianism is called: a) Ahura Mazda b) Angra Mainyu c) Yahweh d) Baal Answer: a) Ahura Mazda

3. The primary sacred text of Zoroastrianism is the: a) Torah b) Avesta c) Vedas d) Quran Answer: b) Avesta
4. The evil/destructive spirit that opposes Ahura Mazda is: a) Ahriman / Angra Mainyu b) Asura c) Mara d) Satan Answer: a) Ahriman / Angra Mainyu
5. Places of worship in Zoroastrianism are commonly known as: a) Fire Temples b) Synagogues c) Shrines d) Pagodas Answer: a) Fire Temples
6. Fire and water are used in Zoroastrianism as symbols of: a) Destruction b) Purity c) Wealth d) Power Answer: b) Purity
7. Structures traditionally used by Zoroastrians for exposure of the dead are: a) Pyramids b) Towers of Silence (Dakhmas) c) Catacombs d) Stupas Answer: b) Towers of Silence (Dakhmas)
8. The core ethical maxim of Zoroastrianism is: a) Fasting, praying, almsgiving b) Good Thoughts, Good Words, Good Deeds c) Silence, meditation, isolation d) Truth, beauty, non-action Answer: b) Good Thoughts, Good Words, Good Deeds
9. Zoroastrianism is historically known as one of the world's oldest _____ religions. a) Polytheistic b) Monotheistic c) Animistic d) Pantheistic Answer: b) Monotheistic
10. Contemporary Zoroastrians in India are commonly known as: a) Parsis b) Punjabis c) Brahmins d) Copts Answer: a) Parsis

Unit 9: Taoism & Confucianism

1. Both Taoism and Confucianism originated in ancient: a) India b) China c) Japan d) Egypt Answer: b) China
2. The traditional founder of Taoism is considered to be: a) Confucius b) Laozi (Lao Tzu) c) Mencius d) Buddha Answer: b) Laozi (Lao Tzu)

3. In Taoism, the natural, flow/way of the universe is called the: a) Dao (Tao) b) Ren c) Karma d) Yin Answer: a) Dao (Tao)
4. The primary text of Taoism written by Laozi is the: a) Analects b) Tao Te Ching c) Five Classics d) Book of Rites Answer: b) Tao Te Ching
5. The core Taoist concept of effortlessness or "non-action" is: a) Wu Wei b) Ren c) Li d) Xiao Answer: a) Wu Wei
6. Confucianism focuses heavily on ethics, governance, and: a) Reincarnation b) Social harmony and filial piety c) Monastic isolation d) Asceticism Answer: b) Social harmony and filial piety
7. The collection of sayings and ideas attributed to Confucius is the: a) Tao Te Ching b) Analects (Lunyu) c) Vedas d) Zhuangzi Answer: b) Analects (Lunyu)
8. In Chinese philosophy, the concept of complementary dual forces (light/dark, passive/active) is: a) Wu Wei b) Yin and Yang c) Dao and Li d) Ren and Li Answer: b) Yin and Yang
9. The Confucian virtue of "Filial Piety" (Xiao) means: a) Love for nature b) Respect and devotion to parents and ancestors c) Non-violence to animals d) Rejection of social rules Answer: b) Respect and devotion to parents and ancestors
10. The core Confucian concept of benevolence, humaneness, or goodness is: a) Li b) Ren (Jen) c) Qi d) Dao Answer: b) Ren (Jen)

Part 2: 10 Important Short Questions (انگریزی میں)

1. Q: What is the significance of studying world religions in the 21st century? *Answer:* Studying world religions promotes mutual tolerance, dispels harmful stereotypes, fosters

interfaith dialogue, enhances social cohesion in multicultural societies, and helps individuals address modern global issues like conflict, climate change, and human rights through a shared ethical framework.

2. Q: Define 'Tawhid' and list its three categories in Islamic theology. *Answer:* Tawhid is the absolute belief in the oneness of Allah. Its three categories are:
    1. *Tawheed Ar-Rububiyyah* (Oneness of Lordship)
    2. *Tawheed Al-Uluhiyyah* (Oneness of Worship)
    3. *Tawheed Al-Asma wa Sifat* (Oneness of Allah's Names and Attributes).
3. Q: What are the primary sacred texts in Judaism? *Answer:* The main scriptures are the Tanakh (Hebrew Bible—comprising the Torah, Nevi'im, and Ketuvim) and the Talmud (which consists of the Mishnah—oral law—and the Gemara—rabbinic commentary).
4. Q: How does the Quran describe the status and birth of Prophet Isa (Jesus)? *Answer:* The Quran honors Isa (AS) as a noble Prophet and Messenger sent to the Children of Israel. It affirms his miraculous virgin birth to Hazrat Maryam without a father by God's command, but strictly rejects his divinity or being the "Son of God".
5. Q: Explain the Quranic stance on the Crucifixion of Jesus. *Answer:* According to Surah An-Nisa (4:157-158), the Quran rejects the notion that Jesus was killed or crucified. It states "it was made to appear so to them," and Allah raised him alive unto Himself.
6. Q: What was the Muslim scholars' contribution to Comparative Religion during the Golden Age? *Answer:* Early

Muslim scholars (like Al-Farabi, Avicenna, Ibn Rushd, Al-Biruni) pioneered rational theological discourse (Kalam), engaged with Greek philosophy, and objectively analyzed Jewish, Christian, and other religious texts and scriptures to foster comparative religious understanding.

7. Q: Briefly describe the Christian doctrine of the Trinity. *Answer:* The Trinity is the Christian belief that there is One God who exists in three distinct, co-equal, and co-eternal persons: God the Father, God the Son (Jesus Christ), and God the Holy Spirit.
8. Q: What is the Golden Calf incident according to the Quran? *Answer:* During Moses' 40-day absence on Mount Sinai, a man named Samiri misled the Israelites into making and worshipping a golden calf idol. It is cited in the Quran as a grave act of idolatry (Shirk) and spiritual failure.
9. Q: Define the sociological terms 'Opium of the people' and 'Social Cement' regarding religion. *Answer:* Karl Marx called religion the "opium of the people," arguing it pacifies the poor to accept inequality. Émile Durkheim viewed religion as "social cement," which unifies communities through collective rituals and values.
10. Q: What are the core components of the Christian New Testament? *Answer:* The New Testament contains 27 books divided into: the 4 Gospels (Matthew, Mark, Luke, John), the Acts of the Apostles, the Pauline and General Epistles (letters), and the Book of Revelation.

Part 3: 4 Important Long Questions ((انگریزی میں

Question 1: Muslim Contribution to the Study of World Religions and Comparative Faiths

- Context & Introduction: Historically, Islamic civilization gave rise to systematic studies of world religions.
- Key Points to Cover:
    1. *Development of Kalam (Scholastic Theology):* How scholars like Al-Ash'ari and Al-Maturidi established rational frameworks to defend Islamic beliefs while engaging with Jewish, Christian, and philosophical ideas.
    2. *Islamic Philosophy in the Golden Age:* The contributions of Al-Farabi, Avicenna (Ibn Sina), and Averroes (Ibn Rushd) in synthesizing Greek philosophy with theology and influencing interfaith discourse.
    3. *Early Comparative Religion & Textual Analysis:* Engagement of early scholars (e.g., Al-Tabari, Ibn Hazm, Al-Biruni) with the Torah, Gospels, and non-Abrahamic traditions.
    4. *Sufism and Mystical Bridges:* The role of Sufi scholars (Rumi, Ibn Arabi, Al-Ghazali) in exploring spiritual experience and universal moral values across faith traditions.

Question 2: Detailed Analysis of Judaism: Core Beliefs, Sacred Scriptures, and the Concept of Covenant

- Context & Introduction: Judaism is one of the world's oldest monotheistic traditions, based on a covenantal relationship between God and the Israelites.
- Key Points to Cover:
    1. *Core Beliefs:* Ethical Monotheism, the Abrahamic/Mosaic Covenants, the concept of the Messiah, and the World to Come (Olam Ha-Ba).
    2. *Sacred Texts:* Structure of the Tanakh (Torah/Pentateuch, Nevi'im, Ketuvim) and the Talmud (Mishnah and Gemara).
    3. *Moral & Ethical Framework:* The Ten Commandments (Decalogue) and its principles on worship, moral conduct, and social justice.
    4. *Prophethood & Moses:* The central role of Prophet Moses (Musa), the Exodus from Egypt, and receiving the Law at Mount Sinai.

Question 3: Comprehensive Comparative Study of Jesus Christ (Isa) and the Injil in Christianity and Islam

- Context & Introduction: Jesus Christ holds a central position in both Christianity and Islam, yet theological perspectives differ significantly.
- Key Points to Cover:
    1. *Nature and Divinity:* Christian view of Jesus as the Son of God, fully divine and human, part of the Trinity; Islamic

view of Isa (AS) as a human prophet, servant of Allah, and messenger.

2. *The Concept of Scripture (Injil vs. Gospels):* Islamic concept of the original Injil directly revealed to Isa versus the Christian New Testament Gospels (Matthew, Mark, Luke, John).
3. *Crucifixion and Salvation:* Christian belief in crucifixion and resurrection as the central act of atonement; Islamic rejection of his crucifixion (Surah An-Nisa 4:157) and belief in his ascension and return.
4. *Status of Maryam (Mary):* Reverence of Virgin Mary in both traditions, highlighting her exalted status in the Quran.

Question 4: Concept of Monotheism (Tawhid) in Islam vs. Trinitarianism in Christianity and Idolatry (Shirk)

- Context & Introduction: Monotheism is the fundamental doctrine defining Abrahamic religions, but its interpretation varies.
- Key Points to Cover:
    1. *Islamic Concept of Tawhid:* Absolute oneness of God categorized into *Rububiyyah* (Lordship), *Uluhiyyah* (Worship), and *Asma wa Sifat* (Attributes).
    2. *Refutation of Shirk:* Definition of Shirk (associating partners with Allah) as the unforgivable sin and its manifestations.
    3. *The Christian Trinity:* The theological explanation of One God in Three Persons (Father, Son, Holy Spirit).

4. *Islamic Critique of Trinity:* Quranic verses emphasizing Tawhid and rejecting division within the divine essence (e.g., Surah Al-Ikhlas, Surah An-Nisa).